

SHEKHAR GHOSH

The Jet Setter

KANIKA TEKRIWAL, 33

Founder and CEO, JetSetGo
Delhi

The founder of JetSetGo—an aggregator service for aircraft, often described as the Ola/ Uber of the skies—Kanika Tekriwal founded the company when she was just 24. She has surmounted major challenges in her journey—a year into developing her business model, Tekriwal was diagnosed with cancer. Nonetheless, she fought her way through, beginning her business with an investment of just Rs 5,600 and without owning a single aircraft. Her business began with an app on which customers could book chartered flights. In the early years, as she sought meetings with potential clients, she was often dismissed and sometimes ignored at meetings, with questions about her business being directed to her male colleagues. With a turnover of Rs 150 crore, her company today has about 200 employees, with offices in Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai and Hyderabad. In 2020-21, Tekriwal's company handled 100,000 fliers—many of them India's rich and powerful, who lease jets from her company to travel for business meetings or election rallies—and operated 6,000 flights. ■

–Shwweta Punj

A BITTER EXPERIENCE Tekriwal was once asked to serve coffee at a meeting she had set up with a potential client